knew that I could not give up my writing. If it came to a choice . . .

I asked for an appointment with Dean Faulkner, and when I kept that appointment, I put it to him frankly. I was a science-fiction writer, I said, had been for years, and the people who hired me knew this was so at the time they hired me.

My first book was coming out in a month or two, under my own name, of course, and my association with the medical school was mentioned on the back cover. I hadn't known it would be, but there it was. Did he want my resignation?

The dean considered thoughtfully (he was a true Boston Brahmin with a long face and an easy smile) and said, "Is it a good book?"

Cautiously, I said, "The publishers think so."

He said, "In that case the medical school will be glad to be identified with it."

That took care of that.

7

Bill Boyd had gone to Egypt at the beginning of September, and I heard from him with fair regularity. He was ecstatic at first but by No-

2 Book publishers pay accumulated earnings twice a year—February and August in Doubleday's case.

vember there was a more sober air to his letters, and he now said that he would definitely be back when his two-year hitch was up.

Roy Machlowitz showed up in Boston on November 25—a breath of the long-dead days in Philadelphia. He was married now and his wife came with him. We had lunch together, visited the glass flowers at the Harvard Museum (which I secretly thought overrated), fed them a swordfish dinner, and all went well.

Talking about dinner, during those early months in Boston, the Boyds and the Whipples introduced me to a club called "The Decadents." The purpose of the club was to meet once a month for some fancy ethnic meal, with each month someone else serving as host. One month, for instance, we went to a restaurant for a Syrian meal. It was my first experience of the Middle Eastern